STHIROS
Strategy. Risk. Cyber. AI.



When a 1,500-Crore retailer's finance function had to be rebuilt from memory into process, in 8 months

A leading FMCG retailer engaged Sthiros to build and transfer a Shared Service Centre for its finance operations, cutting processing effort by 50% and costs by 30%.

Client	Product Deployed	Sector	Geography
Leading FMCG Retailer	**Shared Service Centre Setup, Build-Operate-Transfer (BOT) Model**	**FMCG, Retail**	**India**

The Challenge:

When process lives in people, not systems

This 1,500-Crore FMCG retailer ran invoice processing, treasury, GST reconciliation, and payroll accounting on SAP ERP, but with no documented SOPs, no MIS tracking, and finance fragmented across teams. The original plan proposed a single-phase cutover of every function at once.

No Process Controls
No mechanism existed to catch control lapses across finance functions.

Decentralised Operations
Finance processes were fragmented across teams and locations with no owner.

Undocumented SOPs
Process flows lived in people's heads, making training fragile and dependent.

SoD Conflicts
Non-linear processes and conflicting duties created error and fraud risk.

No MIS Visibility
No mechanism tracked transaction volumes or values, so bottlenecks stayed hidden.

High-Risk Transition Plan
A single-phase, simultaneous cutover of every function risked total failure.

The Solution:

A phased Build-Operate-Transfer, replacing memory with process

Sthiros ran a phased Build-Operate-Transfer engagement, replacing undocumented institutional knowledge with documented process across hiring, knowledge transfer, ERP optimisation, controls, and governance, one stream at a time rather than a single risky cutover.

Every process was documented, signed off by stakeholders, and handed over with fixed turnaround times and MIS tracking in place.

The team's structured approach, from knowledge transfer to process documentation and governance design, delivered results we genuinely did not expect this quickly.

The Methodology

1 Hiring Support & Team Structuring

Suitable profiles identified and technically assessed, with a lean, flat Agile structure enabling faster decisions and a 2x productivity gain.

2 Knowledge Transfer & Process Documentation

Simultaneous knowledge transfer across every finance stream, with documentation reviewed and signed off by stakeholders.

3 ERP System Understanding & Optimisation

SAP workflows mapped end-to-end, with a tailor-made Invoice Routing workflow automating invoice flow from receipt through to posting.

4 Controls Implementation & Backlog Clearance

Maker-checker controls introduced at the transactional level, with accumulated processing backlogs cleared before go-live.

5 Governance Framework & MIS Design

KPI-driven governance and a T+3 processing turnaround established, with offline working capability enabled for continuity.

What This Means

Document it before you transfer it.

Maker-checker catches what speed misses.

Lean teams process twice as fast.

Outcomes

50%

Processing effort reduced

Structured roles, training, and phased knowledge transfer cut manual effort in half.

30%

Cost savings

Centralised, standardised operations delivered from day one of go-live.

2x

Productivity improvement

A lean, flat Agile team structure improved workforce output.

T+3

Fixed processing TAT

Turnaround time standardised across every finance stream, with MIS tracking in place.

Get in touch

Is your finance function still running on memory, or on process?

Speak to Sthiros about what a structured SSC transition can unlock for your finance function.

Connect with us:
sthiros.com

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